The echo command executed successfully. Notice that, unlike when we're running the Rails server, the container terminates immediately after running the command. That's because the echo command completes and returns its exit status, whereas the Rails server's run loop keeps it executing until you ask it to stop (or it crashes). Additionally, since this is a one-off command, we've used the --rm option to delete the container once it completes—otherwise, we'll end up with lots of extra containers lying about.

The second way to run a one-off command avoids starting up a new container altogether. Instead, it relies on a running container, and executes the command on that. This is done with the docker-compose exec command.

Assuming our Rails server is running, we can run our echo example like this:

```
$ docker-compose exec web echo 'ran a different command'
ran a different command
```

Although this only works if a container is already running, since it doesn't start a new container, we don't have to remember to clean up additional containers or use the --rm option.

Rebuilding Our Images

We can ask Compose to build our images for us instead of using the underlying docker build command. This is useful to avoid switching between docker and docker-compose commands, but also because our app may contain Dockerfiles for more than one service; our docker-compose.yml file will keep track of which Dockerfile is used for which service.

To rebuild our Rails app server image, known to Compose as our web service, you would issue the command:

```
$ docker-compose build web
```

There are a few different reasons why you may need to rebuild your image. Often, it's because you've updated your Gemfile and need to reinstall your gems (the Dockerfile contains the bundle install command). Occasionally, it's because you have to modify your Dockerfile to install additional dependencies. Or sometimes you want to share your image and need to include the latest code changes (thanks to the Dockerfile COPY instruction), as we'll see in Part II, Toward Production, on page 127.

Cleaning Up After Ourselves

You may recall that when we first issue the docker-compose up for a project, it creates a network, the volumes, and any containers needed for the app. The